Prahlin Portfolio Work Log - November 4, 2026

Compiled summary for Wednesday, November 4, 2026 - focus: continuing the Prahl.dev Portfolio after the November 3 navigation, workflow, workspace, and alternating-triangle record; explicitly verifying the United States Eastern date; running the customary project reader; extracting and studying the complete pre-existing PDF worklog archive; correcting the sticky navigation's upper masking behavior and stabilizing hero device imagery; completing the My Workflow terminology and inactive-state pass; applying differentiated gradients and responsive spacing to Work Space and Work Tools; replacing the reversible alternating triangles with a Figma-derived five-triangle radial formation; and developing that formation into a symmetric, accessible, depth-oriented cootie-catcher interaction with inward opacity, folded motion, responsive selectors, and organic center-scattered light.

Generated in continuity with the established Prahlin Portfolio worklog format: compact opening summary, source-material review, baseline and goals, feature-grouped implementation details, committed-source sequence, validation, files and artifacts, follow-up notes, and output-artifact close. The record preserves the archive's dense technical voice, explicit repository evidence, dated footer treatment, and distinction between committed source, local verification, reader-generated documentation, and deployment state.

Coverage begins after portfolio_worklog_november3.pdf and documentation commit 3be5d90. Three Portfolio source commits completed November 4: 5229735, 191e83d, and 629e3fc. At documentation time, HEAD, main, origin/main, and origin/HEAD all resolve to 629e3fce780638dd7d9a516ced8c82951b20cd19. The reader-refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt is the only modified tracked file before this PDF is added. No additional source commit, GitHub Actions dispatch, Hostinger synchronization, public deployment, external message, store submission, Figma-file mutation, or ancillary-repository write was performed during this worklog pass.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Date verification: checked an external UTC-05:00 clock and the local America/New_York time zone. Both reported Wednesday, November 4, 2026 after the November 1 daylight-saving transition, so the worklog correctly uses November 4 and EST rather than UTC-04:00 or an unverified execution-host date.
- Project reader: ran ./read_project.sh from /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio and regenerated portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt with current source, assets, repository state, deployment notes, PDF inventory, and standing workflow instructions.
- Worklog archive: enumerated and extracted all 60 pre-existing root-level Portfolio PDFs with pdftotext, from portfolio_worklog_july11.pdf through portfolio_worklog_november3.pdf. Before this artifact, the archive contained 332 pages and approximately 177,372 extracted words.
- Archive comparison: reviewed every PDF's filename and same-day Part suffixes, title and date cadence, page count, opening-summary density, section sequence, feature-grouped bullet voice, validation language, files-touched record, follow-up continuity, output-artifact close, repeated footer, page numbering, and document metadata.
- Nearest baselines: read November 3 in full and compared November 2, November 1, October 22, October 18, September 29 Part 2, representative August records, and the July 11 first entry. November 3 remained the direct implementation baseline; November 2 and October 22 supplied the closest responsive-interaction and landing-navigation history.
- PDF conventions: confirmed mature output as US Letter portrait at 612 x 792 points, unencrypted black Helvetica-family text on white, compact margins, bold section headings, a dated first-page title, repeated dated footers, right-aligned page numbers, and Codex author / creator metadata.
- Repository evidence: reviewed the three November 4 commit messages, timestamps, bodies, statistics, aggregate diffs, synchronized branch refs, current Workflow selector data, landing hero image settings, Work Space / Work Tools visual rules, ProductivityHacks component, eleven new SVG assets, generated snapshot, and local runtime state.
- Figma evidence: used the supplied Portfolio design link and the Frame 15 formation as the design reference during the implementation sequence. Figma remained a read/reference source; code and imported SVG assets changed locally, while the connected Figma design itself was not edited by these repository operations.

Baseline Status Before November 4

- The November 3 sticky navigation had a localized underlay fade, but hero lettering could remain conspicuously visible above the bar because the fade began relative to the screen edge and the masking layer could sit beneath hero assets. The desired result required a solid upper guard and earlier darkening at the navigation boundary.
- Hero screenshot and device-frame imagery could intermittently disappear after a refresh or a down-and-up scroll sequence. The surrounding composition remained present, indicating an image-loading / painting reliability problem rather than intentional responsive hiding.
- My Workflow already had five stages, three points per stage, stronger active hierarchy, and equalized inactive subsections. Inactive fills still needed full visibility on some screens, and the point names required a substantial terminology pass to match the intended discovery-through-upkeep story.
- Work Space and Work Tools had four consolidated groups with aligned white subsections, but all icon / label pairs still shared green styling. Their upper-to-lower gaps and label-to-icon spacing also differed subtly between columns and portrait breakpoints.
- Productivity Hacks ended November 3 as five alternating rounded triangles with A / B / C indicators. It did not yet reflect the supplied Figma Frame 15 radial formation, contain a true shared-center fold, or communicate depth through inward opacity and center-scattered lighting.

Goals for November 4

- Make the sticky navigation's upper boundary visually definitive so no landing asset becomes more visible above the bar than beneath it, while preserving the navigation's established sizing, links, and responsive behavior.
- Stabilize hero device and screenshot frames across refresh and scroll restoration without altering their intended composition.
- Finish Workflow terminology, increase inactive-panel visibility to the requested maximum, and preserve image-caption alignment across all fifteen points.
- Differentiate Work Space / Work Tools icon-label groups with selected gradients while preserving the exact icon drawings and normalizing desktop

and portrait spacing.

- Replace the old Productivity Hacks arrangement with the five-triangle Figma formation while retaining all card content, accessibility, responsive containment, and a reversible asset trail.
- Build a symmetric cootie-catcher interaction whose selected triangle finishes at the vertical top with its outward base up and inward tip down, using depth rather than a flat clockwise carousel.

Work Completed - Navigation Mask and Hero Reliability

- Moved the sticky navigation fade's effective start to the navigation boundary instead of waiting for content to reach the viewport's absolute top edge. This corrected the perceptual inversion in which large hero letters could look brighter in the strip above the bar than under the bar.
- Darkened the top portion of the mask, removed delayed activation, raised the fade layer above the hero artwork, and added a solid guard above the navigation. The combined treatment prevents background assets from peeking through the browser-to-navigation gap during vertical scrolling.
- Preserved the navigation's established brand, CASES / UI / UX / STACK / FLOW / CONTACT content, scroll scaling, and narrow-layout wrapping. The change remained a masking correction rather than a visual redesign of the navigation itself.
- Cleared stale Next.js / Turbopack development output during repeated visual checks when accepted CSS changes did not appear in the running page. Restarting the development server separated cache symptoms from actual selector or stacking problems.
- Stabilized hero screenshot and device-frame visibility by prioritizing their loading path. The frames now remain available after refresh and when scrolling down and back up instead of occasionally failing to repaint.
- Kept hero reliability work scoped to load behavior; no intentional repositioning, scale change, or new visual treatment was introduced for the device composition.

Work Completed - My Workflow Content and Visibility

- Raised inactive Workflow panel background / gradient opacity to 1.0 after intermediate increases remained too faint on some displays. Active-stage hierarchy still comes from its stronger image, border, shadow, typography, and focus treatment rather than from making inactive panels disappear.
- Reworked the first stage's language around discovery and comparison. Industry Analysis now uses Current Trends, Best Practices, and Competitive Advantage; Benchmarks uses Baselines, Targets, and Success Metrics; the remaining discovery point uses Vision, Expectations, and Time table as its A / B / C accent terms.
- Replaced the earlier Discuss / Brainstorm naming sequence with Industry Analysis and Benchmarks so the white headers and colored sublabels describe separate research functions rather than repeating similar ideation words.
- Refined the Prototype point and its media captions. Wireframing and Mockups exchanged their requested positions, Interactive Demo became the C caption, and the yellow gradient labels remain beneath the showcased image and left-aligned to its edge.
- Completed the remaining stage-specific terms: Scoping uses Scoping, Revision, and Log Generation; Build uses Architecture, Implementation, and Integration; Handoff uses Documentation, Knowledge Transfer, and Ownership; Learn uses Findings, Adaptation, and Improvements; and Upkeep uses Maintenance, Optimization, and Support.
- Kept the terms data-driven through WorkflowImageSelector and page-level stage definitions. The content pass did not disturb the existing exclusive point focus, five-stage navigation, responsive rail, or selector accessibility.

Work Completed - Work Space and Work Tools Visual System

- Applied four selected color gradients across the HARDWARE, DEV / CODING, QA DEVS, and ART / DESIGN icon-label pairs. Each icon and its matching colored header now share one gradient identity rather than relying on a uniform green accent.
- Preserved the original icon silhouettes and stroke geometry. Gradient color was wired into the existing shapes and text treatment without redrawing the monitor, code, phone, or palette symbols.
- Increased the vertical separation between upper and lower icon sections by a controlled amount so Smartphones and Visual Design no longer crowd the content above them.
- Normalized the portrait breakpoint so the Work Tools upper-to-lower gap matches the Work Space gap. This removed the visible inconsistency between the Smartphones and Visual Design row starts.
- Moved colored headers closer to their corresponding icons and corrected special offsets affecting the two top groups. The monitor / HARDWARE and code / DEV / CODING pairs now use the same optical relationship as their lower counterparts.
- Retained the white subsection headings, gray inventory text, hardware facts, QA device lists, and the broader two-column shell introduced November 3.

Work Completed - Figma-Derived Productivity Hacks Formation

- Replaced the previous alternating-card experiment with the five-triangle formation from the supplied Portfolio Figma Frame 15. The new system uses jade, solar, violet, electric-blue, and tangerine triangles arranged around one shared visual center.
- Scaled the formation within the landing page's designated central horizontal shell so it stretches across the available presentation area without bleeding beyond the left or right site boundaries.
- Created separate SVG assets for every triangle plus a combined formation reference. Preserved `.previous.svg` copies for each color so the imported design remains reversible without reconstructing prior geometry from Git history.
- Reduced each triangle's band thickness by approximately 50 percent, then added solid inner and outer strokes derived from each gradient's darkest endpoint. The paired strokes sharpen the silhouette while retaining the luminous gradient body.
- Filled the previously transparent interior zones with the matching triangle gradient. The fills follow the same inward visibility logic as the bands, maintaining coherence rather than introducing a flat opaque center.
- Rebuilt the opacity masks from each outward-facing base toward its inward tip. Visibility stays extremely low across the outer half, increases

exponentially toward the shared center, and reaches its strongest value only near the inward endpoint.

- Moved all five triangles inward until their tips nearly meet, then refined corner rounding and endpoint geometry to prevent overlaps, colored slivers, clipping, or unequal black gaps. All five tips now derive from symmetric radial placement rather than individually guessed offsets.
- Preserved all prior functional content: title, triangle-specific icon and icon box, image placeholder, description / keywords, and interactive hit region. Removed the obsolete A / B / C navbar indicators from the graphic as requested.
- Rotated each triangle's internal content with its containing triangle. When a triangle is active at the top, its title sits toward the outward base, its image placeholder occupies the visual middle, and its icon remains nearer the inward tip without clipping the colored geometry.
- Increased and repositioned the internal asset groups through successive passes. Titles, previews, copy, and icon boxes now sit higher within the top-facing triangle's apparent coordinate system, allowing low-visibility outer-base bleed while protecting the strongly visible tip region.

Work Completed - Triangle Interaction, Folding Motion, and Symmetry

- Made the visible triangle and its transparent interior filling clickable through dedicated SVG hit regions. Keyboard focus, activation labels, and button semantics allow the same selection without relying on pointer precision or visible paint.
- Used the existing My Core Beliefs star interaction as a behavior reference, then deliberately changed the motion model. Productivity Hacks does not perform a flat clockwise / counterclockwise carousel; it folds inward and outward like a paper cootie catcher.
- Anchored every fold at its triangle's inward tip and applied a shared perspective system. Outward bases bend away from the viewer toward the landing-page grid while the tips remain fixed around the combined center.
- At the edge-on midpoint, the selected triangle assignment snaps to the vertical top position. The formation then unfolds with that triangle's outward base pointing vertically up and its inward tip pointing down, matching the clarified orientation requirement.
- Removed per-triangle transform-axis approximations that caused some colors to skew or tilt while others folded cleanly. A common radial transform model now keeps all five members visually consistent regardless of their starting angle.
- Derived all angular spacing from one five-way rotation sequence. Equal center radii, equal tip distances, matching corner curves, and consistent z-order prevent one triangle from crowding or clipping an adjacent triangle during rest or transition states.
- Locked new selections during the fold cycle to prevent overlapping animations and inconsistent final state. Reduced-motion users receive the same deterministic selected orientation without the full perspective movement.
- Preserved the triangle design while later interface work was added above it. The selector insertion did not intentionally change the formation's SVG geometry, corner radii, tip spacing, thickness, masks, or internal placement.

Work Completed - Automation / Setup Selector and Organic Lighting

- Recreated the UI / UX Philosophy selector's overall footprint and transition cadence above Productivity Hacks, naming the two states AUTOMATION and SETUP. The desktop control uses the same 583.6 x 128 visual envelope, three-column balance, and directional 300 ms crossfade behavior.
- Added responsive sizing for portrait and narrow layouts while keeping the control centered over the formation. Key / lock artwork and final color exploration were intentionally deferred; this pass established structure and animation logic only.
- Connected selector state without modifying triangle geometry. The formation remains the primary graphic beneath the new navigation and retains its fold interaction independently of the Automation / Setup label transition.
- Added a second outside-to-inside lighting treatment that reads as irregular sunlight scattering from the formation's shared center. It sits behind the content and hit layers, so the effect cannot block interaction or wash over icons as a flat overlay.
- Combined angular ray wedges, soft radial attenuation, unequal lengths, and localized shadow zones to avoid a mechanical starburst. Some outer triangle regions are intentionally brighter or darker than neighboring regions because rays bleed through the composition unevenly.
- Kept the natural-light layer subordinate to the existing exponential triangle masks. The outer bases remain low visibility, the center stays dominant, and the organic rays add depth without replacing the primary opacity system.

Committed Source Sequence

- 5229735 - Refined landing navigation scroll masking and refreshed project documentation. Darkened the sticky navigation fade, removed delayed activation, raised the fade above hero assets, added the solid upper guard, and refreshed the project snapshot.
- 191e83d - Refined landing-page workflow content, workspace visuals, and hero reliability. Added stage-specific A / B / C language, increased inactive Workflow visibility, applied four icon-label gradients, normalized responsive spacing, tightened icon-to-label alignment, and prioritized hero imagery.
- 629e3fc - Rebuilt the Productivity Hacks experience with an interactive five-triangle formation. Added the Figma-derived radial SVG system, inward masks, symmetric tips, click / keyboard hit regions, cootie-catcher folding, Automation / Setup navigation, organic lighting, reduced-motion support, and reversible SVG snapshots.
- The three commits total 1,588 insertions and 217 deletions across sixteen changed or added files relative to documentation commit 3be5d90.
- At documentation time, HEAD, main, origin/main, and origin/HEAD all resolve to 629e3fce780638dd7d9a516ced8c82951b20cd19. No additional source commit or push was performed while generating this record.

Validation Summary

- Verified the Eastern date externally at UTC-05:00 and locally with America/New_York after the daylight-saving transition.
- Ran the standard project reader and reviewed the regenerated snapshot, source tree, Git state, deployment notes, PDF inventory, and standing instructions.
- Extracted all 60 prior worklogs, totaling 332 pages and approximately 177,372 words, and compared their naming, structure, style, metadata, validation language, and output closure.

- npm run check completed successfully; TypeScript reported no errors.
- Reviewed the aggregate November 4 diff and commit-level file statistics. The committed source sequence is synchronized locally and remotely at 629e3fc.
- Local development checks and repeated visual review covered navigation masking, hero persistence, Workflow inactive panels, desktop / portrait workspace spacing, triangle containment, tip symmetry, fold orientation, selector placement, and organic lighting.
- git diff --check reports trailing whitespace inside the reader-generated portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt because that snapshot embeds numbered source excerpts. Application source is committed and clean; the generated snapshot was not manually normalized during documentation.
- No GitHub Actions run, Hostinger synchronization, public deployment, store submission, Figma write, external communication, or ancillary-repository modification was performed during this documentation pass.

Files Touched and Artifacts

- app/ProductivityHacks.tsx - five-triangle content mapping, SVG layer composition, click and keyboard selection, fold-state sequencing, accessibility labels, animation locking, reduced-motion handling, and Automation / Setup state.
- app/WorkflowImageSelector.tsx - expanded stage-specific colored captions and completed Workflow point terminology.
- app/page.tsx - Workflow stage definitions, updated headings and A / B / C terms, prioritized hero imagery, and retained landing-section integration.
- app/globals.css - navigation mask and upper guard; inactive Workflow visibility; workspace gradients and responsive gaps; radial triangle sizing, masks, positioning, internal content, folds, selectors, and organic sunray / shadow layers.
- portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt - reader-generated Portfolio snapshot refreshed before PDF composition.
- public/images/productivity-hacks-figma-formation.svg - combined Figma-derived formation reference.
- public/images/productivity-hacks-figma-{jade,solar,violet,electric-blue,tangerine}-inward-fade.svg - current per-triangle gradient, stroke, fill, and opacity-mask assets.
- public/images/productivity-hacks-figma-{jade,solar,violet,electric-blue,tangerine}-inward-fade.previous.svg - reversible prior copies retained beside the active assets.

Follow-Up Notes

- Treat the radial five-triangle system as geometry-sensitive. Preserve the common center, five-way angular sequence, equal tip radius, shared corner construction, paired dark strokes, and synchronized masks when changing its scale.
- Keep internal content in the triangle-local coordinate system. Future copy or image changes should be checked in every selected top orientation, not judged only from the default formation.
- Retain the fold midpoint handoff and animation lock. Adding independent per-triangle transform origins would reintroduce skew, unequal travel, or mismatched tip spacing.
- Complete the deferred Automation / Setup state visuals only when their content distinction is defined. Do not borrow key / lock artwork or alter triangle geometry merely to fill the selector's central column.
- Preserve the navigation guard as a top-edge occlusion layer. Do not move its fade back to the viewport edge or place hero art above it.
- Keep Workflow inactive fills at the requested full opacity unless a future redesign replaces their active-state hierarchy with a different mechanism.
- Resolve the previously documented GitHub billing lock before treating synchronized refs as evidence of a successful Hostinger deployment.

Output Artifact

- Generated /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_worklog_november4.pdf using the established lowercase-month, unpadded-day naming convention. No Part suffix was needed because no earlier November 4 root-level Portfolio worklog existed.
- The title and filename use Wednesday, November 4, 2026 after explicit EST / UTC-05:00 verification.
- The artifact uses US Letter portrait pages, black Helvetica-family text on white, compact technical bullets, repeated dated footers, right-aligned page numbers, and Codex document metadata.
- The synchronized Portfolio source baseline is 629e3fce780638dd7d9a516ced8c82951b20cd19. The reader-generated snapshot and this PDF are the documentation outputs from this pass.
- No application source change, additional commit, public deployment, external message, Figma mutation, or ancillary-repository update was performed during worklog generation.